Maastricht, Netherlands, October 19, 2026

André Tomano

Post-Doctoral Researcher in Marketing-Finance at Maastricht University

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Affiliations
Maastricht University
School of Business and Economics (SBE)
Department of Marketing & Supply-Chain Management (MSCM)

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The Netherlands

Research Interests
Marketing-Finance Interface, Marketing Strategy, Pricing Power, Investor Communication, NLP, Synthetic Data

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Academic Education

Post-Doctoral Researcher in Marketing-Finance (2026 – ongoing)
Maastricht University – SBE, Netherlands

PhD Candidate in Marketing-Finance (2022 – 2026)
Maastricht University – SBE, Netherlands

M.Sc. in International Business: Track Marketing-Finance (2011 – 2012)
Maastricht University – SBE, Netherlands

B.A. in Business and Economics (2007 – 2011)
Friedrich-Alexander University, Erlangen-Nuremberg, Germany

Research Visits

Visiting PhD Researcher, School of Marketing, UNSW Sydney, Australia (Jan – Apr 2026)
hosted by Prof. Hauke Wetzel

Research Community Service

Co-Director Marketing-Finance Exchange Center of Excellence (MFX COE) (2022 – present)

Member of the MSCM Department PhD Social Committee (2023 – 2026)

Finance Department PhD Representative at the GSBE PhD Committee (2023 – 2025)

Research Projects

Working Papers

Talk the Walk: Predicting Pricing Power Using Top Management Teams' Language

Pricing power (PP) – the ability of firms to raise or sustain prices without curtailing demand – is a fundamental driver of long-term value creation. Established accounting measures like the price–cost margin (PCM) are retrospective and cost-contaminated; they confound price-driven margin gains with cost cuts and fail to anticipate a change in a firm's pricing position before it materializes.

Using linguistic dependency parsing on firms' earnings calls, this study develops a continuous, firm-level measure of communicated PP, decomposed into a *realized* and an *expected* PP signal.

Applied to 55,664 firm-quarters covering 3,138 US firms from 2018 to 2024, the *realized* component aligns contemporaneously with the accounting proxies, and the *expected* component anticipates future PCM, showing that managerial language moves before the accounting record.

The study offers a forward-looking, cost-clean and scalable measure of PP that complements the existing proxies, which can be applied ad-hoc to any firm communication.

Market Your Share! How Marketing Capability and its Communication Drive Firm Value through Analyst & Investor Relationships

Valuing assets that drive future firm performance is a pivotal but difficult task for financial analysts and investors. This study investigates how Analyst & Investor Relationships (AIR), as a strategic market-based asset, impacts firm valuation.

Using a comprehensive survey-based measure of AIR across 1,159 U.S. firms from 2015 to 2020, we find that AIR contributes positively to firm value, measured by Total q. Drawing on resource-based theory, we identify marketing capabilities (MC) as a critical antecedent: firms with superior MC exhibit stronger AIR, and communicating MC during earnings calls strengthens this conversion. Further moderation analyses reveal that analyst coverage weakens the link between MC and AIR, but amplifies the relationship between AIR and firm value, whereas institutional ownership attenuates the latter.

These findings demonstrate that a firm's ability to market its shares is context-dependent, contributing to literature by revealing the nuanced pathways through which MC and AIR generate firm value.

Ongoing Projects

Synthetic Measurement of Pricing Power
MFX COE × Evidenza.AI (Dec 2025 – present) – Lead Researcher

Market research increasingly relies on synthetic respondents: customer panels simulated by large language models. This project asks whether their answers reflect real differences between firms. We field established price-sensitivity tests on synthetic buyer panels and compare the resulting price elasticities, firm by firm, with financial measures of pricing power.

- **Design:** Gabor–Granger-style price tests for a cross-industry sample of U.S. pure-play firms, with shifted reference prices to separate genuine price sensitivity from anchoring on the price shown
- **Benchmarks:** price–cost margin, profit elasticity, and the text-based pricing-power measure from *Talk the Walk*
- **Next phase:** a buyer-side, multi-dimensional pricing-power questionnaire, aggregated into a single score
- **Status (Oct 2026):** pilot completed; full-sample validation in progress

Industry Partnerships

Evidenza.AI (Dec 2025 – present)
- Lead Researcher on an 18-month externally funded research collaboration between MFX COE and Evidenza.AI on the use of synthetic data in marketing-finance research
- Responsible for initiating, negotiating, and leading the partnership

Academic References

Joost M.E. Pennings (Supervisor)
- Professor in Finance
- Professor of Marketing
- Department of Marketing & Supply-Chain Management
- SBE, Maastricht University, Netherlands

Niels Holtrop (Co-Supervisor)
- Associate Professor of Marketing
- Department of Marketing and Supply Chain Management
- SBE, Maastricht University, Netherlands

Thomas Post (Co-Supervisor)
- Associate Professor in Finance
- Department of Finance
- SBE, Maastricht University, Netherlands

Teaching

Teaching Assistant for Maastricht University – SBE, Netherlands (2022 - present)
- Academic Skills and Competences, Pre-Masters
- Entrepreneurial Finance, M.Sc.
- Shareholder Value & Market-Based Assets, M.Sc.
- Sustainable Financial Management and Policy, B.Sc.

Bachelor / Master Thesis Supervision

Master Thesis Supervision (2026/2027): 1 Students

Master Thesis Supervision (2025/2026): 5 Students

Bachelor Thesis Supervision (2025/2026): 29 Students

Master Thesis Supervision (2024/2025): 4 Students

Master Thesis Supervision (2023/2024): 6 Students

Master Thesis Supervision (2022/2023): 2 Students

Academic Conference Presentations

1. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T., Wetzel, H. (2026), "Talk the Walk! A New Measurement of Pricing Power Using Top Management Team's Language", 55th EMAC Annual Conference, 03-05 June, 2026, Bath School of Management, Bath, UK
2. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T., Wetzel, H. (2026), "Talk the Walk! A New Measurement of Pricing Power Using Top Management Team's Language", Marketing Analytics Symposium Sydney, 23-24 February, 2026, International Convention Centre, Darling Harbour, Sydney, Australia
3. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T. (2024), "Market Your Share! Marketing Capabilities, Investor Relations and Firm Performance", 46th ISMS Marketing Science Conference, 27-29 June, 2024, International Convention Centre, Darling Harbour, Sydney, Australia.
4. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T. (2024), "Market Your Share! Marketing Capabilities, Investor Relations and Firm Performance", 53rd EMAC Annual Conference, 29-31 May, 2024, Bucharest University of Economic Studies, Bucharest, Romania.
5. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T. (2024), "Market Your Share! Marketing Capabilities, Investor Relations and Firm Performance", EMAC Doctoral Colloquium, 26-28 May, 2024, Bucharest University of Economic Studies, Bucharest, Romania.
6. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T. (2024), "Market Your Share! Marketing Capabilities, Investor Relations and Firm Performance", 8th Marketing Strategy Meets Wall Street Conference, 22-24 May, 2024, Maternushaus, Cologne, Germany.
7. **Tomano, A.,** Holtrop, N., Pennings, JME., Post, T. (2024), "Market Your Share! Marketing Capabilities, Investor Relations and Firm Performance", Groningen Invitational Research Camp 2024, 25-26 April, The Market Hotel, Groningen, Netherlands

Industry Employment

Senior Coverage Specialist – Institutional (2017 – 2022)
DWS Group, Frankfurt, Germany

- Management (i.e. first point of contact) of existing institutional client relationships in Corporate Germany, including tasks such as: strategic & tactical asset allocation advisory, structuring of pension funding, providing liquidity solutions for corporate treasury, organisation of client review meetings
- New client acquisition via Private, Wealth & Commercial Clients and Corporate & Investment Banking from Deutsche Bank AG, including tasks such as answering RFPs, participating in pitches / beauty contests, conducting market / client research
- Regular presentation of institutional coverage and current market trends in asset management on internal or external events (such as: semi-annual Maastricht University Guest Lecture, DB Marketplace, DWS Graduate Introduction, UM Frankfurt Banking Tour)
- Responsible for talent pipeline and new joiners for institutional coverage Germany

Senior RFP Writer (2014 – 2017)

DWS Group, Frankfurt, Germany

- RFP Specialist and Back-up Pipeline Manager for the EMEA & Asia-Pac Business Development Team
- Pipeline Management, i.e. assignment, coordination, and review of all incoming RFPs speaking to the Active, Passive, and Alternative Asset Classes, totalling around 800 requests which were assigned to a team of 15 people, located in 3 cities on 2 continents
- Completion of RFIs/RFPs/DDQs for the Active, Passive and Alternative Asset Classes
- On-site training of new joiners as well as training via video calls / telephone
- Content review and structural optimisation of RFP database

Consultant for Financial & Accounting Advisory Services (2014)
EY, Frankfurt, Germany

- Conducted & executed various projects for commercial banks and asset managers (i.e. ISAE 3402 audit, AQR, Section 44 BaFIN audit)

Regional Sales Management Trainee (2013 – 2014)
ALDI GmbH & Co. KG, Roth, Germany

RFP Writer & Sales Support Intern (2012 – 2013)
DWS Group, Frankfurt, Germany

Professional Education

Certified European Financial Analyst (CEFA) (2021)
Deutsche Vereinigung für Finanzanalyse und Asset Management (DVFA), Frankfurt, Germany

Certified International Investment Analyst (CIIA) (2022)
Deutsche Vereinigung für Finanzanalyse und Asset Management (DVFA), Frankfurt, Germany

Professional Associations

Member of DVFA Germany, Frankfurt, Germany (2021 – present)

Community Service

Founding member & coach of a calisthenics sports group (2017 – present)
The Social Workout Crew (IG: sowot.ffm), Frankfurt, Germany

- Hosting of training sessions twice a week with an average of 50 to 100 participants
- Creating local brand awareness via social media
- Collaborations with Adidas Runners and VIDAR Sport
- Organisation of events / get-togethers

Languages

German (native); English (fluent); Spanish (conversant); Dutch (conversant)